

Editorial

Young Tongue And Old Gold

AS I MEET and discuss with the various departments under the *Digit* banner, I get a feeling that the age bracket of readers has, over the years, shifted. While a few years ago the average age of the *Digit* reader would not have crossed 22, today it is much higher. Just to substantiate: we are running a daily contest for *Digit* subscriptions on our Web site, and guess what: over 40 per cent of the contenders are over the age of 40. I get about three letters on an average, per day, from readers over 35 years of age. So is it true that some cool, funky technologies are only for the young and restless? Data says otherwise...

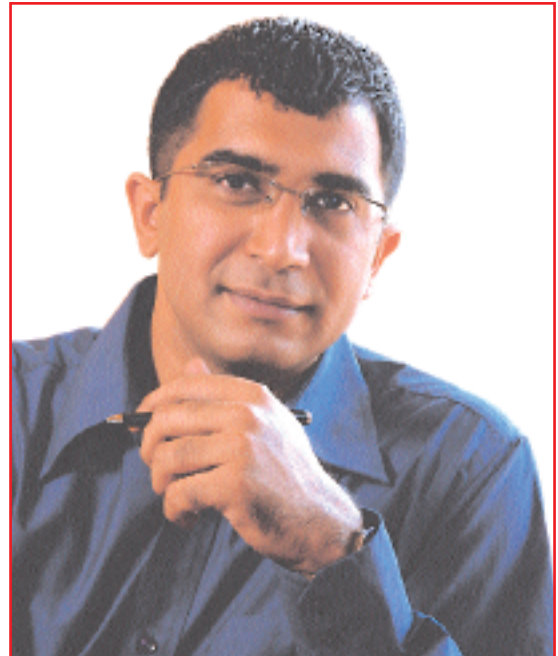
They say the youth is fleeting; well, maybe in the gaming world. This definitely is not the case in the IT industry. Remember the tech stalwarts: Bill Gates, who started Microsoft at the age of 19, and Steve Jobs, who started Apple at 21? What is happening to the youth of today? Looks like they are fleeing!

The revelations that I have received remind me of the famous *Charms* cigarette case study. The cigarette was launched in a denim pack, to target youth in the 18-to-25 age bracket. But when a survey was undertaken, it was found out that the pack was being lapped up by smokers in the 35-plus age category. The reason—smokers in the 35-plus age category wanted to relive their youth, so they found the pack attractive—much more than did the intended target audience. (I'm not condoning this mental association, but facts are facts.)

Now coming back to *Digit*: do we spot a similar trend in the readership profile of the magazine? The 40-somethings are individuals who grew up on the cusp of the IT wave. Since that is a generation which has dramatically seen how IT can impact their personal and professional lives, maybe it wants to ensure that it stays on the cutting edge of technology. Naturally, people from this generation are readers of *Digit*.

The youth, on the other hand, has not seen how life used to be in all fields before the dawn of the IT revolution. And how life used to be before *Digit*.

Maybe I'm reading too much into the phenomenon, but it just goes to show that a digital divide



Sujay Nair Editorial Director

"The youth has not seen how life used to be before the dawn of the IT revolution"

does not exist between the earlier generation and the current one. In the years gone by, you would have expected a strong case of IT phobia in the older generation. Remember the strikes that used to happen in certain sections of the industry to protest computerisation? When Big Blue was shown the door on a political whim? In this day and age, IT has become the holy grail, as the desktop has become ubiquitous in every organisation.

IT has now become an inclusive technology. That is to say, it does not exclude anyone from reaping the benefits of technology utilisation.

The jury is still out on this one. I would love to hear from your side on this issue—and I am sure that I'll get to listen to a fair share of "veteran" voices!

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